

FEDERAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION
FOI/PA
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Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : Mr. A. H. Belmont

DATE: May 29, 1951

FROM : C. H. Stanley

SUBJECT: ELBERT DUNCAN THOMAS - Formerly
High Commissioner, Trust Territory,
Pacific Islands
Department of the Navy
Fleet Post Office
San Francisco, California
LOYALTY OF GOVERNMENT EMPLOYEES

Tolson
Ladd
Clegg
Glavin
Nichols
Rosen
Tracy
Belmont
Mohr
Tele. Room
Nease
Gandy

PURPOSE:

ELBERT DUNCAN THOMAS

To advise that a loyalty form has been received on the captioned individual and to recommend that the Liaison Section advise the Department of the Navy that that agency is in possession of all information contained in the files of this Bureau concerning the appointee and that no investigation will be conducted in this matter in the absence of a specific request from the Department of the Navy.

BACKGROUND:

Bureau files reflect that an applicant type investigation was conducted on the appointee, who is a former Senator from the State of Utah, in May, 1949. This investigation was requested by the Department of Labor, inasmuch as Thomas was proposed as a delegate to the 32nd International Labor Conference in Switzerland in June, 1949. Thomas later became unable to attend and the Department of Labor requested discontinuance of the investigation. RUC reports had been received from all auxiliary offices, but due to the nature of the information developed, the Department of Labor was advised that, since the investigation was not completed, no reports would be forwarded to the State Department.

The information developed was as follows:

The House Committee on un-American Activities indicated that Thomas was listed as having sent greetings to the National Conference of the International Labor Defense in 1939. The international Labor Defense has been cited by the Attorney General as being within the purview of Executive Order 9835. Thomas was listed in 1943 as a sponsor of the National Council of American Soviet Friendship, an organization cited by the Attorney General. Thomas submitted several articles to "New Masses," cited by the House Committee on un-American Activities as "a Communist publication."

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Thomas was listed as a sponsor of a dinner given by the Joint Anti-Fascist Refugee Committee, an organization cited by the Attorney General. Investigation also disclosed that Thomas was associated with David Zablodowsky and Edward I. Aronow. Zablodowsky has been described as "a Communist of the vicious type," and Aronow had been very active in the campaign to free Earl Browder. (77-43250-31)

Subsequent to the above investigation, Thomas made vague complaints that the investigation was improper, and the persons interviewed were not advised that it was an administrative investigation, and also that his political opponents were interviewed during the course of the investigation. It was determined that these complaints were unfounded, and Thomas was so advised. Nevertheless, he continued to criticize the Bureau and knowingly made misstatements concerning the investigation. He was still unjustifiably criticizing the Bureau to a representative of Peyton Ford's Office as late as August, 1950. (77-43250-1, 3, 19, 21, 29)

On or about January 1, 1951, a name-check request was received from the Office of Naval Intelligence with respect to the appointee, and it was ascertained by Supervisor C. D. DeLoach that Thomas was to be nominated as Governor of one of the Islands under Navy jurisdiction.

A summary memorandum was prepared incorporating all the information developed during the course of the applicant type investigation conducted in May, 1949, on the appointee, and also all information received subsequent to the completion of that investigation. With the approval of the Director, the attached summary memorandum was provided to ONI under date of January 9, 1951. (77-43250-31)

Since the transmission of the above-mentioned summary memorandum to ONI, the following additional information is contained in Bureau files concerning the appointee.

"Counterattack" magazine, in its issue dated January 12, 1951, set forth an article on Thomas, noting that on January 3, 1951, President Truman appointed Thomas High Commissioner of the Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands. This article set forth quotes from various writings, speeches and activities of Thomas, indicating his pro-Russian attitude. Some of these observations are as follows:

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"In 1943, he wrote as follows for the Communist magazine, 'New Masses':

'In the future, when we make an estimate of Soviet leadership, we will see that it is based upon the finest of Democratic principles, the cultivation and the development of the people by providing proper education, proper health, proper hospitalization, and proper social opportunities. I cannot speak personally of any of the leaders of the Soviet regime. I do not know them. But if by their fruits ye shall know them, we must know them as true leaders of men.'

"He has supported and spoken at meetings of Communist Party (CP) fronts, such as the American Committee for Protection of the Foreign Born, Independent Citizens Committee of the Arts, Sciences, and Professions, American Youth Congress, National Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Committee of One Thousand (formed to fight for abolition of the HCUA). He was a member of Board of Trustees of the Institute of Pacific Relations when Fred Vanderbilt Field and Owen Lattimore were prominent in it.

"Thomas sponsored a Committee for the First Amendment, which was formed to fight the investigation of Communism in Hollywood, and took part in its 'Hollywood Fights Back' radio broadcast. This committee questioned right of Congress to ask any man about his 'political' views."

In addition to the above article in "Counterattack," Bureau files contain a "throw-away" called "The United States Senate News," which contains articles and features indicating a pro-Russian and pro-Communist attitude on the part of Thomas, which "throw-away" was used to attack Thomas during the past election, in which he was defeated. This "throw-away" contained an excerpt from one of the Director's speeches, and a search of the files failed to locate any evidence that at any time was the author given permission to reprint this excerpt from the Director's speech. It was noted on January 30, 1951, that there was a move on in the Senate for a Senate investigation of the attacks on Thomas, especially as it appeared in "The United States Senate News" and also some talk of possible criminal prosecution for the misuse of the mail and the violation of the Corrupt Practices Act to be possibly initiated by the United States Senate against the authors of the publication. (77-43250-34)

The files of the Security Division of the Department of State reflected that Elbert D. Thomas, U. S. Senator from Utah, attended the Institute of Pacific Relations, Triennial Conference, held at Mont Tremblant, P. Q. Canada, December 4, to December 14, 1942.

The records of the Institute of Pacific Relations reflect that Senator Elbert D. Thomas, U. S. Senator for the state of Utah, was on the Board of Trustees of the Institute of Pacific Relations in 1943.

RECOMMENDATION:

In view of the above, namely, that Thomas is presently an appointee to a position under the Department of the Navy and complete information has been furnished to that agency under date of January 9, 1951, it is recommended that the Liaison Section contact the Navy and furnish them with the attached Blind Memorandum containing information received subsequent to the previous memorandum afforded them. The Department of the Navy should be advised that they are in possession of all pertinent information concerning the appointee contained in Bureau files, and no investigation will be conducted on Thomas in the absence of a specific request. The information contained in the "throw-away" is not being furnished, due to its nature and its utilization during the elections in Utah.)

If approved, the Liaison Section should advise the Navy as set out above, and the results of this contact should be furnished to the Loyalty Section in order that the loyalty form on the appointee may be returned to the Civil Service Commission with a statement on the reverse side thereof to the effect that the employing agency is in possession of all pertinent information concerning the appointee contained in the files of this Bureau, and no investigation will be conducted in this matter.

MI advised
in accordance
with recommendation
Blind memo - Res furnish
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REQUEST FOR REPORT OF LOYALTY DATA ON APPLICANTS AND APPOINTEES

THIS FORM TO BE USED ONLY FOR APPLICANTS AND APPOINTEES
WHERE RECORD CHECKS AND INQUIRIES ARE CONDUCTED
BY CIVIL SERVICE COMMISSION
(PART 1—EXECUTIVE ORDER 9835)

CASE SERIAL NO.
(OSO use only)

1251104252

TO: The Federal Bureau of Investigation, through the U. S. Civil Service Commission
The following information is furnished for identification purposes on the person named below. Kindly furnish a report on any loyalty information contained in your files. (The fingerprints of this person are attached.)

1. FULL NAME (Initials and abridgments of full name are not acceptable).		(Surname) THOMAS		(Given name) ELBERT	(Middle or other names) DUNCAN										
2. ALIASES AND NICKNAMES		none		3. DATE OF THIS REQUEST Jan. 8, 1951											
4. SPECIAL NUMBERS KNOWN TO REQUESTING AGENCY (FBI number or FBI file number, passport number, Army or Navy serial number, seaman's certificate of identification, alien registration number, Social Security number, etc. Specify which) none															
5. PLACE OF BIRTH Salt Lake City, Utah		6. DATE OF BIRTH June 17, 1883		7. TITLE OF POSITION High Commissioner, Trust Territory, Pac. Isl.											
8. SEX ☒ MALE ☐ FEMALE	9. MARITAL STATUS ☐ SINGLE ☒ MARRIED		10. IF MARRIED, GIVE SPOUSE'S FULL NAME, AND DATE AND PLACE OF BIRTH Ethel Evans Thomas												
11. DATE OF APPOINTMENT 8 Jan, 1951		12. TYPE OF APPOINTMENT: ☒ EXCEPTED ☐ COMPETITIVE (Cite Civil Service or other legal authority) ☐ TEMPORARY													
13. ORGANIZATIONS WITH WHICH AFFILIATED OTHER THAN RELIGIOUS OR POLITICAL ORGANIZATIONS OR THOSE WHICH SHOW RELIGIOUS OR POLITICAL AFFILIATIONS Vice President of American Society of International Law Vice President American Political Science Association															
14. DATES AND PLACES OF RESIDENCE FOR THE LAST 10 YEARS <table border="1"><thead><tr><th>From</th><th>To</th><th>Street</th><th>City</th><th>State</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1940</td><td>1951</td><td>3200 16th Str. N.W.</td><td>Washington</td><td>D.C.</td></tr></tbody></table>						From	To	Street	City	State	1940	1951	3200 16th Str. N.W.	Washington	D.C.
From	To	Street	City	State											
1940	1951	3200 16th Str. N.W.	Washington	D.C.											
15. DATES, NAMES AND ADDRESSES OF EMPLOYERS FOR THE LAST 10 YEARS <table border="1"><thead><tr><th>Date</th><th>Employer</th><th>Address</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1933</td><td>1951</td><td>United States Senate</td><td>Washington, D.C.</td></tr></tbody></table>						Date	Employer	Address	1933	1951	United States Senate	Washington, D.C.			
Date	Employer	Address													
1933	1951	United States Senate	Washington, D.C.												
16. THIS AGENCY HAS LOYALTY INFORMATION REPORT(S) FURNISHED BY THE AGENCIES INDICATED BELOW: <table border="1"><thead><tr><th>AGENCY WHICH MADE THE LOYALTY REPORT</th><th>DATE OF REPORT</th><th>REMARKS</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr></tbody></table>						AGENCY WHICH MADE THE LOYALTY REPORT	DATE OF REPORT	REMARKS							
AGENCY WHICH MADE THE LOYALTY REPORT	DATE OF REPORT	REMARKS													
17. THIS SPACE RESERVED FOR RETURN REPORT NO ADDITIONAL DATA NO DEROGATORY INFORMATION IS DEVELOPED FBI FILES			18. NAME AND ADDRESS OF REQUESTING AGENCY High Commissioner Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands Fleet Post Office, Operations San Francisco, California												

JUN 29 1951

The files of this Bureau reflect that all pertinent information concerning the appointee contained in the files of this Bureau has been provided to the employing agency, and investigation will be conducted in this matter in the absence of a specific request. Investigation will be conducted in the absence of a specific request.

The above is furnished for your confidential information and should not be disseminated to any unauthorized individuals or agencies. This is not to be considered as a clearance or disapproval of this appointee. (77-43250)

AM:raw

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FBI, Washington, D. C.

(Name of Reporting Agency)

INSTRUCTIONS ON PREPARATION OF STANDARD FORM 85

1. This form (Standard Form 85) is promulgated by the United States Civil Service Commission at the request of the Federal Bureau of Investigation for the purpose of carrying out the responsibilities with respect to applicants for Federal employment and persons appointed to Federal positions after September 30, 1947, as provided in Part 1 of Executive Order 9835.
2. All items must be filled in. If the answer is "No" or "None", so state.
3. The Fingerprint Chart (Standard Form 87) of the applicant or appointee must be submitted with the original and two copies of this form. The third carbon copy of the form should be retained by the agency.
4. If additional space is needed in filling in Items 14 and 15, use a separate sheet of paper, number the item to correspond with the item number of this form, and attach.
5. If the requesting agency has previously received loyalty information from any Government agency (including the Federal Bureau of Investigation) concerning the employee named in this form, the name of the agency which furnished the information and the date of the report should be shown in Item 16.
6. Item 17 is reserved for use in reporting on this request when no derogatory information is developed.
7. Whenever information is developed the report will be covered in Item 19 above.
8. For further details regarding the use of this form see the Federal Personnel Manual, Chapter 12.

BY SPECIAL MESSENGER

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Date: January 18, 1952

To: Mr. James E. Hatcher
Chief, Investigations Division
U. S. Civil Service Commission
Washington 25, D. C.

From: John Edgar Hoover, Director, Federal Bureau of Investigation

Subject: ELBERT DUNCAN THOMAS
High Commissioner - Appointee
Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands
Department of the Interior
Washington, D. C.
LOYALTY OF GOVERNMENT EMPLOYEES

Reference is made to your case serial number 12.51.104252 relating to the above-named appointee concerning whom you referred to this Bureau a request by Mr. Guy W. Numbers, Director of Personnel, Department of the Interior, Washington, D. C., for information in the files of this Bureau.

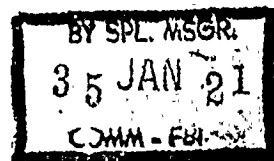
The requested information is enclosed for transmittal to the Department of the Interior. The enclosure consists of ~~confidential~~ information and should not be disseminated to unauthorized persons or agencies. It is not intended as a clearance or nonclearance of the appointee for Federal employment.

No investigation of the appointee under Executive Order 9835 is contemplated in the absence of a specific request.

Enclosure

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Nichols _____
Belmont _____
Clegg _____
Glavin _____
Harbo _____
Rosen _____
Tracy _____
Mohr _____
Tele. Rm. _____
Nease _____
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SECURITY INFORMATION - CONFIDENTIAL

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U.S. DEPT. OF JUSTICE

~~SECURITY INFORMATION - CONFIDENTIAL~~

January 18, 1952

MEMORANDUM

Re: ELBERT DUNCAN THOMAS
High Commissioner
Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands
Department of the Interior
Washington, D. C.

An investigation concerning Elbert Duncan Thomas was initiated by the FBI in May, 1949, at the request of the Department of Labor under the provisions of Public Law 843, 80th Congress, due to the fact that Thomas was proposed as a delegate to the 32nd International Labor Conference at Geneva, Switzerland, which began June 8, 1949. This investigation was discontinued at the request of the Department of Labor due to Senator Thomas' inability to attend the Conference.

BACKGROUND:

The official Congressional Directory, 80th Congress, 2nd Session, June, 1948, listed the following biographical information for Thomas:

Democrat of Salt Lake City, Utah; born, Salt Lake City, June 17, 1883; A.B. (Utah, 1906), Ph.D. (California, 1924), LL.D. (Southern California, 1935), Litt.D. (National, 1937); Oberlaender Award (1934); professor, political science, University of Utah; vice president, American Society of International Law; chairman, Thomas Jefferson Memorial Commission; associate moderator of President's 1941 Industry-Labor Conference; national delegate, International Labor Organization Conference at Philadelphia, 1944, Paris, 1945, Montreal, 1946, and Geneva, 1947; American member of the International Commission for the Adjustment of Disputes between South Africa and the United States; member of the United States Princeton University Bicentennial Commission; sometime director, Columbia Institute for the Deaf; vice president, American Political Science Association; fellow and visiting professor, University of California; major, Inspector General's Department (U. S. Utah and U. S. Reserves); president, Japan Mission; member, Carnegie European Conference of American Professors; member, Committee

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W.W. Warren:rl

ENCLOSURE

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U.S. DEPT. OF JUSTICE
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DIRECTOR

Intellectual Cooperation, Interparliamentary Union; and member, American Council of Learned Societies; author: Suki No Michi (1911), Chinese Political Thought (1927), World Unity Through Study of History (1933), Thomas Jefferson, World Citizen (1942), and the Four Fears (1944); married Edna Harker, 1907 (died 1942); married Ethel Evans, 1946; three daughters--Chiyo, Esther (Mrs. Wayne C. Grover), and Edna Louise (Mrs. Lawrence L. Hansen); elected to the Senate November 8, 1932; re-elected November 8, 1938, and November 7, 1944.

INFORMATION SET FORTH IN RECORDS OF
HOUSE COMMITTEE ON UN-AMERICAN ACTIVITIES:

The records of the House Committee on Un-American Activities reflected the following information concerning Thomas:

Thomas was listed in the HCUA records, Appendix 9, page 840, among those sending greetings and messages to the conference held by the National Conference of the International Labor Defense in Washington, D. C., July 8, 1939.

Thomas was listed in "Equal Justice" July, 1939, page 4, as one who sent greetings to the National Conference wishing the Conference of the International Labor Defense success.

Thomas was also listed in the "Proceedings and Report," page 35, date not given, of the National Conference of the International Labor Defense.

The International Labor Defense has been cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General.

He was listed in "New Masses," dated December 16, 1941, page 29, as a proposed speaker at a rally to be held December 17, 1941, sponsored by the Committee of Jewish Writers and Artists in the United States.

"New Masses" was cited by the House Committee on Un-American Activities in its report dated March 29, 1944, pages 48 and 75, as a Communist publication. The American Committee of Jewish Writers, Artists and Scientists was cited by the California Legislative Committee on Un-American Activities in its 1947 report, page 45, as a Communist front organization.

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Thomas was listed in the "New York Times," dated May 18, 1943, as a sponsor of the National Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Inc., according to the HCUA records, Appendix 9, page 1200.

The National Council for American-Soviet Friendship has been cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General.

Thomas has submitted the following articles to "New Masses": "What Is Your Estimate of Soviet Leadership?" dated June 22, 1943, page 10; "Italian Problems," dated October 26, 1943, page 12; and an editorial on Bill 637, "Federal Aid to Public Education," dated November 2, 1943, page 8.

He was listed as one of the sponsors of a dinner given by the Joint Anti-Fascist Refugee Committee, according to HCUA record Appendix 9, page 942.

The Joint Anti-Fascist Refugee Committee has been cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General.

Thomas' name was listed as a sponsor on the letterhead of the National Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Inc., dated March 13, 1946. He was also listed as a sponsor of this organization on a memorandum issued by the Council on March 18, 1946. He delivered an address entitled "Two Revolutions" at a rally held by the National Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Inc., in honor of three Soviet writers at Madison Square Garden, New York, on May 9, 1946.

Thomas was listed in the "People's Daily World" in an article by the Committee for the First Amendment as a signer of a statement dated October 29, 1947, page 3, attacking the House Committee on Un-American Activities.

The "People's Daily World" has been cited as "the official organ of the Communist Party on the West Coast" by the House Committee on Un-American Activities in its report dated March 29, 1944, page 95. It was also cited in report dated January 3, 1941, page 10.

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The Committee for the First Amendment has been cited as a Communist front organization by the California Legislative Committee on Un-American Activities in its 1948 report, page 210.

Thomas was named by the "Daily Worker," May 14, 1948, page 3, as a proposed speaker to the American Committee of Jewish Writers, Artists and Scientists at the Polo Grounds, New York, May 15, 1948.

The "Daily Worker" is an East Coast Communist newspaper.

He was also listed in the "Daily Worker," June 3, 1948, page 3, as a proposed speaker at a luncheon to be held by the Committee of One Thousand sometime during June of 1948.

The Committee of One Thousand has been cited as a Communist front by the California Committee on Un-American Activities in its 1948 report, pages 34 and 35.

The House Committee on Un-American Activities' records, Appendix 9, page 481, reflected that he was a sponsor for the 10th Anniversary in the United States of the American-Soviet Friendship Congress. On page 1604 of the same records he was listed among those paying tribute to the fighting forces of our Soviet allies in the magazine "Soviet Russia Today," no date given.

"Soviet Russia Today" was cited as a Communist publication by the House Committee on Un-American Activities in its report dated March 29, 1944, page 167. It was also cited in the report of June 25, 1942, page 21. (77-43250-4)

INFORMATION CONCERNING THOMAS' ASSOCIATION WITH
DAVID ZABLODOWSKY AND EDWARD I. ARONOW AND HIS
EFFORTS TO FREE EARL BROWDER:

A confidential informant of known reliability advised about 1942 that David Zablodowsky had stated that he, Zablodowsky, was aiding in the preparations for the publication of a book on Thomas Jefferson by Senator Elbert D. Thomas. Zablodowsky said that he had practically rewritten the entire book which he expected

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would be published in April, 1942. Zablodowsky indicated that it was his understanding that Edward I. Aronow was acting as an agent for Senator Thomas in connection with the publication of this book. (77-43250-8, p. 16)

The informant said that Zablodowsky and other individuals having contact with Communist matters in New York City had indicated that Aronow was endeavoring to influence Senator Thomas apparently in connection with efforts to obtain the release of an individual from incarceration. While Zablodowsky and the others did not identify this individual in their comments, the informant pointed out that it was during this period that Aronow was active in efforts to obtain the release of Earl Browder, New York Chairman of the Communist Party, from the Federal Penitentiary at Atlanta, Georgia.

Another confidential informant of normal reliability stated that he had known Zablodowsky personally for many years. He declared that he had known Zablodowsky to be a member of the Communist Party and that Zablodowsky had made the statement that he was a Communist Party member in 1936. The informant further described him as "a Communist of the vicious type," and said that he was a member of the League of American Writers and the Trade Union Unity League and that he was known as the "Communist Party whip in the Book and Magazine Guild." The League of American Writers has been cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General, and the Trade Union Unity League has been cited by him as "openly supported and dominated by the Communist Party." (77-43250-8, p. 17)

It was reliably reported in 1945 that Edward I. Aronow, attorney, 165 Broadway, New York City, had been a very active participant in the campaign to free Earl Browder. Aronow incurred expenses in behalf of Browder over a period extending at least from October 2, 1941, to May 21, 1942, and he submitted statements of such expenses to Robert Minor, Assistant General Secretary, Communist Party, USA. Aronow frequented Communist Party headquarters in New York at regular intervals during this period.

A confidential informant of known reliability in 1945 furnished a copy of an undated letter which had been in Aronow's possession. This letter is as follows:

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"The President
The White House
Washington, D. C.

"My dear Mr. President:

"I did not know Mr. Browder. I have seen him once. He does not come from my state; in fact, he has fewer friends there than in any other state. I am not well informed in law or in practice, but from what I have read or been told I believe his sentence was more against the man than for the crimes he committed. Even so, that has happened before and it can be brushed aside. But should it be?

"I say that much because I know the importance of Russia in our international relations and the importance of labor's unity and past effort in our national endeavor.

"Therefore may I suggest that if the administration is ultimately to look favorably upon reducing Browder's four-year sentence, it act now. If the sentences on the two counts for which he was convicted had been allowed to run concurrently instead of consecutively, the commonly accepted time for the consideration of his case would have been passed several months ago. If the sentences are added, next July, I am told, will bring normally a consideration of his case.

"I have debated with myself whether or not I should write this letter and please know, Mr. President, I am sending it only in a spirit of helpfulness. If it is out of place or untimely, please dismiss it, for no one understands better than I the burdens of your task.

"Most sincerely yours,

ELBERT D. THOMAS."

(77-43250-8, p. 13)

A reliable confidential informant advised that Aronow had a telegram addressed to him from Elbert D. Thomas dated February 20, 1942, which read as follows:

"Just received the following from the President:
'I have been giving some thought to this, and expect
to take it up with the Attorney General soon.'"

A pencilled note on this telegram stated as follows:

"I mailed this because the letter is directly
from the President. It should be, therefore, kept in
confidence."

A confidential informant of known reliability stated
that Edward I. Aronow had received a letter dated June 2, 1944,
from Gloria Draper, Secretary to Senator Elbert D. Thomas. The
informant said this letter dealt with the election campaign of
Senator Thomas and offered suggestions to Aronow for his assistance
in this campaign. (77-43250-8, p. 14)

A reliable confidential informant stated that Edward I.
Aronow had received a telegram from Elbert D. Thomas dated June 27,
1944, which read as follows:

"I cannot reach the gentleman I promised to
phone today. Will try tomorrow. Regards

Elbert D. Thomas."

(77-43250-8, p. 12)

A confidential informant of known reliability, in 1945,
furnished the following copy of a typewritten memorandum which
had been in the possession of Edward I. Aronow:

"Matters Undertaken by Aronow for Senator
Thomas' Campaign for Re-Election"

"1. Thomas Jefferson. \$375 to be paid by Aronow
to the Crown Publishing Company upon delivery of 2500
copies of Thomas Jefferson for sale in Utah book shops.
Aronow further guarantees any loss that may be sustained
in the publication of this edition.

"2. Order 25,000 campaign buttons for Thomas.

"3. Order poster photographs (Re-Elect Senator
Thomas). These photographs to be sent to Ritter.

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"4. Obtain 25,000 reprints of Scope Magazine biographical sketch.

"5. Obtain reprint of 25,000 to 50,000 copies of 'New Masses' biographical sketch of Senator Thomas.

"6. Arrange, if possible, an employment of a publicity person to work out of Salt Lake City.

"7. Aronow to obtain letter from Norman Gould to the editor of the 'Herald Tribune' or 'New York Times' in support of Senator Thomas for re-election based upon the need for world markets with concentration on China by way of adoption of Thomas' I.L.O. policy, whereby increase of living standards to Chinese workers to provide purchasing power to China to support the export market from America, thereby saving American business from calamity upon cancellation of war orders.

"Note

"Campaign material to be sent to Mr. Roscoe Bowden, Democrat State Chairman, Newhouse Hotel, Salt Lake City, Utah. Notice of such shipment should be made to Mr. Willis W. Ritter, 907 Walker Bank Building, Salt Lake City, Utah, telephone no. Salt Lake City, 5-3741.

"Aronow undertakes to obtain entry 'four fears' on the P. M. recommended list." (77-43250-8, pp. 14, 15)

INFORMATION RECEIVED FROM OTHER SOURCES:

The Congressional Record for April 11, 1938, contained a reprint of a speech delivered by Senator Elbert D. Thomas before a meeting of the National Lawyers Guild.

The National Lawyers Guild was cited as a Communist front by the House Committee on Un-American Activities in its report dated March 29, 1944, page 149.

A confidential informant of normal reliability stated that Senator Elbert D. Thomas was a speaker at a dinner held by Russian War Relief at the Waldorf Astoria Hotel on November, 19, 1942, opening the "Thanks-To-Russia Month." The informant said

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that the speakers praised Russia as the defender of civilization against Fascism and that "Senator Thomas was particularly enthusiastic about goldbrick Soviet democracy."

The "Daily Worker" of February 24, 1943, contained an article quoting "excerpts" from a speech of Senator Elbert D. Thomas delivered at the 25th Red Army Anniversary Dinner held at the Hotel Commodore in New York City on the preceding Monday.

In this speech, according to the "Daily Worker," Thomas stated, "Soviet Russia's first twenty-five years of history resemble our own first twenty-five years. The ideals of the American revolution struck so hard at age-old injustices that of course the revolution was misunderstood from one end of our world to the other. The Russian revolution also struck at age-old injustices and it, too, was bound to be misunderstood. Both revolutions today though, can be judged in their true light by their accomplishments. Tonight we turn to the idealism behind each revolution. The sacrifices of each makes insignificant every purpose except the idealistic aspirations upon which both revolutions rest."

"...America and Russia came into this war as chance allies forced to fight back aggressive attacks. They are today fast becoming nationalized because the freedom of men, women and children is becoming their joint objective."

A folder was distributed advertising the "United Nations in America Dinner" to be given by the American Committee for the Protection of Foreign Born on April 17, 1943. Senator Elbert D. Thomas was listed on this folder among the sponsors of the dinner.

The American Committee for the Protection of the Foreign Born has been cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General.

The "Daily Worker" for June 20, 1943, quoted Senator Elbert D. Thomas of Utah as praising the war efforts of the Russian Army. The "Daily Worker" for September 29, 1943, contained an article stating that Senator Elbert D. Thomas was listed among sponsors of the 10th Anniversary United States-Soviet Friendship Congress. This article stated further that the Congress referred to was to celebrate the 10th Anniversary of American-Soviet

diplomatic relations and was to be held November 6, 7, and 8, 1943, according to an announcement by Corliss Lamont, Chairman of the National Council of American-Soviet Friendship.

Louis Budenz, Assistant Professor, Fordham University, New York City, and former Managing Editor of the "Daily Worker" until October, 1945, stated that at one time, probably in 1943 or 1944, he interviewed Senator Elbert D. Thomas of Utah. Budenz stated that Earl Browder, at that time National Chairman of the Communist Party, had personally sent him to interview Thomas. He stated that Joe North of "New Masses" and Edward I. Aronow, an attorney, were also present at the interview. Aronow, acting in the capacity of a sort of "middleman" in the conversation. Budenz stated that the purpose of the above-mentioned interview with Senator Thomas was to cultivate Thomas in an effort to get him to use his influence on behalf of the Chinese Communist faction, inasmuch as Thomas had resided in the Orient and was considered an authority on Chinese matters. Budenz stated that he, North, and Aronow endeavored to flatter Thomas, praising his knowledge of Chinese affairs. Concerning Edward I. Aronow, Budenz said that he had no evidence to establish Communist Party membership on the part of Aronow, but that he, Budenz, felt sure that Aronow was a Communist Party member. Budenz also mentioned that Earl Browder said that he, Browder, was on very friendly terms with Senator Thomas. In conclusion, Budenz advised that he knew of nothing to indicate that the purpose of the above-mentioned interview, namely, to influence Senator Thomas in favor of the Chinese Communists, was ever successful.

A confidential informant of known reliability furnished an announcement of a dinner honoring the 25th Anniversary of the Red Army which was to be held on February 22, 1944, under the auspices of the magazine "Soviet Russia Today" and a number of individuals. This announcement reflected that the Honorable Elbert D. Thomas, United States Senator from Utah, was scheduled to be among the sponsors paying tribute to the Red Army.

"Soviet Russia Today" has been cited as a Communist front by the House Committee on Un-American Activities in its reports dated March 29, 1944, and June 25, 1942.

A normally reliable confidential informant advised that Senator Elbert D. Thomas made a speech at a dinner on May 16, 1944, in celebration of the 10th Anniversary of the Autonomous Region

of the U.S.S.R. sponsored by Ambijan at the Waldorf Astoria Hotel. According to the informant, Thomas in his speech stated that he had just come from the sessions of the International Labor Defense in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, and that he was impressed with the prospects of "this organization" to help in the shaping of a better world after the war.

Ambijan was cited as a Communist front by the House Committee on Un-American Activities in its reports dated March 29, 1944, and May 29, 1946.

The "Daily Worker" of November 12, 1944, listed Senator Elbert D. Thomas among sponsors of the United States-Soviet friendship celebrations throughout the country in connection with the November 16, 1944, anniversary of the establishment of diplomatic relations between the two countries. A folder was distributed entitled "Call to the Congress of American-Soviet Friendship" commemorating the 10th Anniversary of American-Soviet relations, which Congress was scheduled for November 6, 7, and 8, 1944. The folder bore the name of the National Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Inc., and listed Senator Elbert D. Thomas among prominent sponsors of the Congress.

A normally reliable confidential informant advised that United States Senator Elbert D. Thomas addressed a dinner at the Waldorf Astoria Hotel in New York City, on November 25, or 26, 1944, sponsored by the National Conference of Ambijan Committee. In this speech, according to the informant, Senator Thomas extended congratulations to the Soviet Government and referred to the way in which the Soviet Union solved the question of national minority rights.

Informant also stated that Senator Thomas described Birobidjan as a haven for the Jewish people and wished success to the Ambijan Committee in the work of the resettlement of Jews in Birobidjan.

A confidential informant of known reliability advised that Howard Selsam, Director of the Jefferson School of Social Science in New York City, advised in December, 1944, that he was considering Senator Elbert D. Thomas of Utah as one who might be obtained to speak at the First Anniversary Dinner of the Jefferson School which was to take place February 5, 1945. Informant did not know whether Thomas did speak at this dinner.

121-35708-2

The Jefferson School of Social Science has been cited as a Communist organization by the Attorney General.

A reliable confidential informant advised in August, 1944, that Luke Woodward Wilson, who claimed to have worked for the United States Senate Subcommittee on Education and Labor as an investigator under Senators Robert M. LaFollette and Elbert D. Thomas, had contacted Senator Thomas requesting that one John McTernan be placed in the National Labor Relations Board branch in Los Angeles, California, and that Senator Thomas had assured Wilson that he was doing all he could to further McTernan's appointment. It has been reliably reported that both Luke Woodward Wilson and John McTernan were members of the Communist Party.

A reliable confidential informant advised that on August 13, 1945, Mrs. Grace Granich visited the office of Senator Elbert D. Thomas, Room 442, Senate Office Building, Washington, D. C. She was accompanied by Tung Pi-Wu, a Chinese delegate to the United Nations, and his secretary, Chang Han-Fu. Concerning Grace Granich, it has been reliably reported that she studied in Moscow in 1932 and later engaged in Communist activities in China. She was registered as an agent of a Russian principal, inasmuch as she was operator of "Inter-Continent News." She received special commissions from the Communist Party and when officials of the "Daily Worker" learned that she was planning to attend the United Nations Conference in San Francisco, they selected her to report on the conference for the "People's World." Following the conference, Mrs. Granich returned to New York with Tung Pi-Wu and Chang Han-Fu.

Records of the Department of Institutes, University of California Extension School, in 1949 reflected that that Department and the California Labor School had sponsored an Institute on Labor, Education, and World Peace on May 3 and 4, 1946, at Wheeler Hall, University of California. Holland Roberts, a member of the faculty of the California Labor School, was the chairman of the opening general session and he introduced Elbert Thomas, United States Senator from Utah, as the main speaker at this session. Holland Roberts has been reliably reported to have been a member of the Communist Party. The California Labor School has been cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General.

121-35208-2

- 18 -

Dr. Baldwin Woods, Director of the University of California Extension School, advised that the Institute of Labor, Education, and World Peace was under the administration of the University Extension School with co-sponsorship of the California Labor School. Dr. Woods said that he personally requested Senator Thomas to speak at the Institute as a guest of the University and that he did not recall that Thomas' name was suggested by the California Labor School. Dr. Woods declared he had read Thomas' speech and described it as "a good American speech." He recalled that Thomas complained after his speech that he had not been properly informed by the University regarding the nature of the group to which he spoke. He had apparently been under the impression that he would be speaking to University students and had not realized that there would be such a large representation of labor unions in the audience.

A confidential informant of normal reliability advised that Senator Elbert Thomas of Utah was one of the speakers at a Soviet American Friendship rally at Madison Square Garden on May 29, 1946, to welcome three Soviet Russian writers.

The October, 1946, issue of "Fraternal Outlook," official publication of the International Workers Order, contained a photograph of three individuals identified in the caption as Konstantin Simonov, Soviet writer; Albert Kahn, President, Jewish People's Fraternal Order, International Workers Order, author of "The Great Conspiracy"; and Senator Elbert D. Thomas of Utah. The caption under the picture stated, "American-Soviet Friendship was Theme of Big Rally in Madison Square Garden." No further information concerning this rally was set forth.

The International Workers Order was cited as a Communist organization by the United States Attorney General.

The "Morning Freiheit" for May 17, 1948, contained an article which purported to summarize remarks made by Senator Elbert D. Thomas as a speaker at "Salute to the Jewish State," attended by 40,000 people and arranged by the American Committee of Jewish Writers, Artists, and Scientists, which meeting was held at the Polo Grounds, New York City, on the evening of May 15, 1948.

The "Morning Freiheit" has been cited as a Communist newspaper by the United States Attorney General. (77-43250-8)

121-75708-2

During the course of the FBI investigation and prior to its discontinuance, neighbors and associates of Thomas at Washington, D. C., Salt Lake City, Los Angeles, and Berkeley, California, were interviewed and all of them recommended him as a loyal citizen. Either no record or a favorable record concerning him was found at the law enforcement and credit agencies in each of these cities. No derogatory information was set forth in records pertaining to him at the Department of State; the National Guard of the State of Utah; the University of Utah, Salt Lake City, Utah; The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints, Salt Lake City, Utah; the University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California; and the University of California, Berkeley, California. (77-43250-4, p. 6-11)

A prominent official of the State of Utah advised in 1949 that Elbert D. Thomas in his opinion was misguided in his social philosophy and that his too-friendly attitude toward Russia was not to the best interest of this country. He believed that Thomas was sincere in his thoughts and he did not question Thomas' intention to be loyal to the United States Government. However, this official said that he disliked to see a man with Thomas' philosophy hold such an important Governmental position as that of Senator.

An officer of the American Legion, Salt Lake City, Utah, advised that in his opinion, formed from observation over a number of years through the American Legion, that the actions and speeches of Elbert D. Thomas indicated that he was not entirely as loyal as one would expect from his background and experience. This officer stated, however, that in his opinion, Thomas should always remain fundamentally loyal to the United States. (77-43250-9, p. 5)

INFORMATION RECEIVED SUBSEQUENT TO THE DISCONTINUANCE
OF FBI INVESTIGATION:

The files of another Government agency which conducts security and personnel investigations reflect that Elbert D. Thomas, United States Senator from Utah, attended the Institute of Pacific Relations Triennial Conference held at Mont Tremblant, Canada, from December 4 to December 14, 1948. (100-64700-436, p. 28)

121-35208-2

The records of the Institute of Pacific Relations reflect that Senator Elbert D. Thomas, United States Senator from the State of Utah, was on the Board of Trustees of the Institute of Pacific Relations in 1948. (100-64700-364, p. 58)

The Institute of Pacific Relations, founded in 1925 in Hawaii, is an organization engaged in research on the economic, political, and social aspects of countries bordering on the Pacific Ocean. Allegations have been received from confidential sources of this Bureau that during the 1930's the Institute of Pacific Relations was used as a "cover" by Soviet military intelligence agents. Allegations have also been received from Louis Budenz, Communist Party functionary from 1935-1945 and former editor of the "Daily Worker" (an east coast Communist publication), that the Institute of Pacific Relations was infiltrated and controlled by the Communist Party beginning in 1936. Numerous individuals connected with the Institute, either in an official capacity or as contributors to its publications "Pacific Affairs" and "Far Eastern Survey," have been cited by Budenz as members of the Communist Party, including Edward C. Carter, Frederick V. Field, Harriet L. Moore, Owen Lattimore, Joseph Barnes, all of whom held principal offices in the Institute during the 1930's. The California Committee on Un-American Activities in its 1948 report cited the American Council, Institute of Pacific Relations, as a Communist front which received funds from the American People's Fund, another front organized and directed by Frederick V. Field as a repository for funds to be distributed to Communist enterprises.

The "Daily Worker" for May 24, 1948, page 2, column 1, contained an article stating that Senator Elbert Thomas (D-Utah), would be the main speaker at a luncheon to be held in June at the Hotel Biltmore, New York City, to mobilize the fight against the Mundt Bill, according to an announcement by the Committee of One Thousand which was to sponsor the luncheon.

The "New York Times" for June 4, 1948, contained an article to the effect that Senator Elbert D. Thomas (D-Utah) denounced the Mundt-Nixon Bill as a threat to the "American right to openly and freely discuss and criticize political and social ideas." The article stated that Senator Thomas was speaking at a luncheon meeting of the Committee of One Thousand at the Hotel Biltmore in New York City and stated that he told the members of the Committee that if Thomas Jefferson were alive today he would be denounced as a Communist "in the spirit of the Mundt-Nixon Bill." (100-353406-26, p. 4)

121-35708-2

A letterhead of the National Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Inc., 114 East 32nd Street, New York City, dated July 6, 1949, listed Hon. Elbert D. Thomas as a sponsor of that organization. (100-146964-1477, p. 5)

On August 29, 1950, Miss Marilyn R. Allen, Salt Lake City, Utah, furnished to the FBI copies of a pamphlet she had written entitled "Challenge to the Republicans in 1950 (Let's 'Can' Senator Thomas.)" This pamphlet attacks Thomas for his "Communism-Internationalism."

The "Washington Evening Star" on October 16, 1950, printed an article entitled "Thomas' Opponent Hurls Red Issue Into Utah Senate Race - Bennett Accuses Him of Having Sympathized With Communist Fronts," by Gould Lincoln. This article stated in part: "Senator Thomas is being charged--not with being a Communist but with having given aid and comfort to Communist front organizations."

The column entitled "These Days" by George Sokolsky in the Washington "Times Herald" on October 27, 1950, and again on October 30, 1950, concerned Senator Elbert D. Thomas of Utah. These columns criticized Thomas for his association with Communists and Communist front organizations and also criticized the content of his book, the "Four Fears," published in 1944. (77-43250-A)

An article appearing in the January 12, 1951, issue of the magazine "Counterattack," states as follows:

"Dear Subscriber:

"WHAT DO YOU THINK OF THIS 'NATIONAL EMERGENCY' APPOINTMENT? After serving in the Senate for 18 years, Sen Elbert D Thomas (D-Utah) was defeated in recent elections. On Jan 8, Pres Truman appointed him High Commissioner of the Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands. This territory consists of the Carolines, Marianas (excluding Guam) and Marshall Islands which, like the Philippines, are in the path of Sino-Soviet expansion in the Pacific.

"But attitude of ex-Senator Thomas toward Stalin Russia and its front agencies in U.S casts doubt on his fitness for this position."

121 35708 -2

"In 1943 he wrote as follows for the Communist magazine, 'New Masses': 'In the future when we make an estimate of Soviet leadership, we will see that it is based upon the finest of democratic principles, the cultivation and the development of the people by providing proper education, proper health, proper hospitalization, and proper social opportunities. I cannot speak personally of any of the leaders of the Soviet regime. I do not know them. But if "by their fruits ye shall know them," we must call them true leaders of men.'

"Thomas, in one of his books (he has written five) published in 1944, wrote that 'all close students' agreed that Stalin had given up his hopes for world revolution ('close students' actually did not agree on this at all) but that 'anti-Russian forces...will make every attempt to discredit Russia, to throw doubt on her motives and intentions, and to make Americans, especially, believe that Russia is the most to be feared of all powers...They will make us believe that the Russians have deep-laid plans to rule the world, to change all Governments by force, to absorb all Europe...'

"He has supported and spoken at meetings of Communist Party (CP) fronts such as the American Committee for Protection of Foreign Born, Independent Citizens Committee of the Arts, Sciences and Professions, American Youth Congress, Nat'l Council of American-Soviet Friendship, Committee of 1000 (formed to fight for abolition of House Committee on Un-American Activities). He was a member of bd of trustees of Institute of Pacific Relations when Frederick Vanderbilt Field and Owen Lattimore were prominent in it.

"In mid-1946 he spoke at rally of the American Committee of Jewish Writers, Artists and Scientists, a Communist front. Communist Paul Robeson, Communist propagandist Albert E. Kahn, and Arthur Osman, leader of new and powerful Distributive, Processing and Office Workers Union and a delegate to at least one CP convention, were also 'stars' of the rally.

"Thomas sponsored the Committee for the First Amendment which was formed to fight the investigation of Communism in Hollywood and took part in its 'Hollywood Fights Back' radio broadcast. This Committee questioned the right of Congress to ask any man about his 'political' views.

"Rep Mike Monroney (D-Okla) charged last May that Thomas had been talking too much about nat'l defense secrets. Earlier, the Munitions Bd complained when Thomas revealed exact figures of U S stockpiling... and Gen Omar Bradley was infuriated when Thomas gave reporters the general analysis of the world situation... which was supposed to be kept secret.

"Now, in a time of crisis, the security of the U S Pacific Trust Territory is in the hands of Elbert D Thomas...who was rejected by his constituents just a few months ago and who for years was apparently duped by Moscow propaganda and Communist fronts in the U S.

"Couldn't Pres Truman have picked someone in whom the American people could have complete confidence to fill this important position?"

The foregoing information is furnished to you as the result of a request for an FBI file check only and is not to be considered as a clearance or nonclearance of the individual involved. It is for your confidential use only and is not to be disseminated to unauthorized persons or agencies. No additional investigation is contemplated in the absence of a specific request.

UNITED STATES CIVIL SERVICE COMMISSION
WASHINGTON 25, D. C.

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b7C
ADDRESS ONLY
"CIVIL SERVICE COMMISSION"
IN YOUR REPLY REFER
FILE I:HC
AND DATE OF THIS LETTER

December 21, 1951

~~PERSONAL AND CONFIDENTIAL~~ - BY SPECIAL MESSENGER

Honorable J. Edgar Hoover
Director, Federal Bureau of Investigation
Washington 25, D. C.

Dear Mr. Hoover:

Reference is made to the case of Elbert Duncan Thomas, born June 17, 1883, High Commissioner, Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands, Department of the Interior, Washington, D. C.

Loyalty forms were submitted to the Twelfth U. S. Civil Service Region, San Francisco, California, by the Department of the Navy for initiation of record check and inquiry in subject's case, in connection with his appointment on January 8, 1951 to the position of High Commissioner, Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands. At that time this position was under the jurisdiction of the Department of the Navy.

Standard Form 85 was returned to this office by your Bureau with a report dated June 29, 1951 under Item 19. Since the position of High Commissioner, Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands, is now under the jurisdiction of the Department of the Interior, this latter agency was furnished the information noted under Item 19 of Standard Form 85.

There is now forwarded herewith a letter to this office dated December 14, 1951 from Mr. Guy W. Numbers, Director of Personnel, Office of the Secretary, Department of the Interior, Washington, D. C., requesting that the agency be advised of any information which the Federal Bureau of Investigation may have relating to Elbert Duncan Thomas.

Very truly yours,

James E. Hatcher, Chief
Investigations Division

RECORDED

121 - 35708 - 2

121 - 35708 - 2

ENCLOSURE ATTACHED
1 ENC.
memo to Belmont
let. to Hatcher
Blank memo
www

SERVICE UNIT
SEARCH SLIP

4-22a

Supervisor Warren Room 2260

Subj: Thomas, Elbert Duncan

☐ Exact Spelling

☐ All References

☒ Subversive Ref.

☐ Main File

☒ Restricted to ~~Locality of~~

Ref. since 5-51

Searchers

Initial Wm

Date 1-10-52

FILE NUMBER

SERIALS

77-43250

77-43250-31 summary

77-43250-36 summary

Thomas, Elbert D.

67-27060

77-43250

62-28691

9-6628

100-15252-56 encl. p. 411

Thomas, Elbert

77-43250

121-35708-2

b3
b7E

Office Memorandum • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

TO : MR. A. H. BELMONT *AB*

FROM : C. H. Stanley *CS*

SUBJECT: ELBERT DUNCAN THOMAS
High Commissioner - Appointee
Trust Territory of the Pacific Islands
Department of the Interior
Washington, D. C.
LOYALTY OF GOVERNMENT EMPLOYEES

DATE: January 16, 1951

Tolson ☒

Ladd ☐

Clegg ☐

Glavin ☐

Nichols ☒

Rosen ☐

Tracy ☐

Harbo ☐

Belmont ☐

Mohr ☐

Tele. Room ☐

Nease ☐

Andy ☐

PURPOSE:

To advise you that the Civil Service Commission has referred to the Bureau a request by the Interior Department Loyalty Board for information in FBI files concerning the appointee, it being noted that the appointee's position was formerly under the jurisdiction of the Navy and is now under the jurisdiction of the Interior Department.

BACKGROUND:

Reference is made to a Summary Memorandum dated May 29, 1951, concerning appointee which was prepared following receipt of appointee's loyalty form. This memorandum relates that an applicant type investigation of appointee was conducted in 1949 (Bureau file 77-43250), and that a memorandum incorporating information developed during the previous investigation was furnished Navy with the Director's approval on January 9, 1951. It was recommended that additional information received subsequent to January 9, 1951, be furnished to Navy in memorandum form, and this was done by a supplemental memorandum dated June 4, 1951.

The Summary Memorandum of May 29, 1951, is attached for your information.

RECOMMENDATION:

121 - 35708 - 3

That the attached blank memorandum, which incorporates the information contained in the memorandum prepared for Navy on January 9, 1951, and the memorandum containing supplemental information which was prepared for the Navy on June 4, 1951, be approved and furnished to the Civil Service Commission for transmittal to the Department of the Interior in accordance with the latter's request. Also attached is a cover letter of transmittal to the Civil Service Commission, advising that no additional investigation will be conducted in the absence of a specific request.

121-35108
Attachments

WWW:rl

RECORDED

121-35708 - 3

JAN 25 1951



DECLASSIFICATION AUTHORITY DERIVED FROM:
FBI AUTOMATIC DECLASSIFICATION GUIDE
DATE 09-28-2021 BY:

UNITED STATES
DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR
OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY
WASHINGTON 25, D. C.

Received 12-18-51
Office of the Chief
Investigations Division

December 14, 1951

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b7C

~~Confidential~~

Mr. James E. Hatcher
Chief, Investigations Division
Civil Service Commission
Washington 25, D. C.

My dear Mr. Hatcher:

Reference is made to your letter of December 12, 1951, transmitting certain information concerning Elbert Duncan Thomas, born June 17, 1883, who received an excepted appointment on January 8, 1951, to the position of High Commissioner, Trust Territory, Pacific Islands.

The Interior Department Loyalty Board has requested that we obtain the information concerning the appointee in the files of the FBI and we would appreciate your obtaining this information for us so that it may be referred to the board for its further consideration of this case.

Sincerely yours,

Guy W. Numbers
Guy W. Numbers
Director of Personnel

121-35708-2

Lit & CSC
bank memo attached
Memo to Mr. Belmont
1-16-52

35708-2

35108-2